

Identification

Records identified through database searching (n = 587)
PubMed/MEDLINE (n = 234)
Scopus, new (n = 326) · Web of Science, new (n = 27)

Screening

Records screened (n = 587)

Excluded as secondary literature
(review, meta-analysis, editorial)
(n = 231)

Eligibility

Primary studies (n = 356)
reporting an accuracy measure in title/abstract (n = 129)

Recall check of records with no
accuracy statement in the abstract
(n = 227)
Plausible on title/abstract (n = 90)
No open full text, not assessed (n = 53)
Full text not retrievable (n = 3)
Full texts read (n = 34)

Full texts retrieved and assessed for eligibility (n = 82)
48 from the abstract-based arm, 34 from the recall check
77 studies contributed 251 extracted estimates

Estimates excluded from
primary pool, reason recorded
(n = 134)

Included

Estimates eligible for the primary pool (n = 117)
case-vs-healthy-control design, 47 independent studies

Circulating estimates with a computable standard error,
included in the PRIMARY pooled meta-analysis (n = 97)
from 37 independent studies

No computable standard error: no CI and
no usable group sizes (n = 17)

Cerebrospinal fluid, SE computable
but not a circulating biofluid:
reported separately, not pooled (n = 3)